PES1UG24AM126

Identified issues and applied fixes:

Issue	Type	Line(s)	Description	Fix Approach
Mutable default arg	Bug / Quality	10	`participants=[]` shared across function calls	Changed default argument to `None` and initialized `participants = []` inside the function.
Insecure Hashing	Security (Bandit)	14	Use of weak MD5 hash function (`hashlib.md5`)	Replaced `hashlib.md5` with secure `hashlib.sha256`.
Broad Exception	Code Quality	20	Catching generic `Exception`	Replaced generic catch with `ZeroDivisionError`.
PEP 8 Formatting	Style (Flake8)	1, 5	Missing module docstrings and improper spacing	Added docstrings, removed unused imports, and fixed spacing.